



Tokyo

Again not exactly the easiest city in the world to venture out by yourself, because no one understands a word of what you are saying! Going out in Japan can be a massive culture shock to any outsider. So the trick is not to get taken aback by the things you see.

SUSHI: First things first, ask your hotel concierge where he has sushi, because if there is one thing they make well in Japan, it's sushi.

AKIHABARA: If there is something else they make well in Japan is electronics-so, no matter how little time you've in your hands, you need to go to the Akihabara (Akiba) district. This is the spiritual home of the Otaku, a group of people with a maniacal devotion to new electronics and anime/manga. Don't worry, these people aren't dangerous they are the culture leaders in global electronics and are usually years ahead of the curve. Much like Japanese school girls, they pretty much define several global fashion trends. The rising popularity of Akihabara in the recent past has seen several new stores, bars and restaurants (And importantly in Japan-many more karaoke bars) open up in the district making it a great place to hang out even if you don't like electronics.



Shanghai

HUAIHAI ROAD AND XIANGYANG ROAD: There are few places in the world where you can get such tremendous bargains, even though what you end up buying is "Chinese Original". The place to go is Huaihai Road, if you want the big brands, but Xiangyang road is where you get the bargains.

XIANTIANDI: It is unlikely that you will have an evening free in Shanghai. But if you do, make sure that you make your way down to the fairly new night life district, Xiantianti. It is not cheap but this is where young Chinese executives hang out, so going there even for a few drinks is not a bad idea.

BUND: If you don't want a drink, go down to the bund, the historic old quarter of Shanghai with buildings dating back to 90-100 years. The original HSBC building still stands there, look over the river onto the Pudong district, a sign of China's incredible progress.